



BRAND LOYALTY & ENGAGEMENT

CRM & MESSAGING

MAY, 2025



© 2024 Merkle, Inc. All Rights Reserved. Confidential.



OFFERING SUMMARY

CRM & Messaging

WHAT IT IS

Messaging – through email, SMS, chat and other touchpoints – is one of the most effective growth levers many brands operate. This offering looks holistically at the CRM & messaging strategy, tech, and operations to ensure great customer experience and strong business outcomes.

This offering puts us at the heart of commercial operations for brands and offers many paths to account growth.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- **Increased** conversion and revenue impact from getting the right message in front of the right customer at the right time.
- **Faster customer acquisition** and zero-party data collection
- **Better 1:1 engagement** driven by channel and messaging relevancy
- **Improved delivery accuracy and deliverability** to keep messaging programs healthy and profitable
- **Integrate CRM and Media** through connected, personalized experiences

WEDGE

Can be delivered at less than \$100k USD, to 'open the door'.

Messaging Tech Assessment

\$80K - \$100K USD

Launch January 2024

Messaging Strategy Assessment

\$80K - \$100K USD

CRM Strategy Blueprint

\$100-\$350K USD

CRM Implementation or Migration

\$150K-\$1M USD

Intelligent Messaging

\$75K-\$500K+ USD

ENGAGEMENTS

Are over \$100k USD that you can sell individually or together.



What's in this document?

Everything you need to get started with our CRM & Messaging offering.

1. **The story:** Presentation-ready materials that you can use in client and prospect meetings. Slides include speakers notes.
2. **Offering definition:** The details of what you can sell – packages with guide pricing, defined activities, deliverables and timelines.
3. **Sales support:** Materials to help you understand and sell the offering
4. **About our GTM:** background information on Merkle's 2024 GTM and business architecture.

Where can I find more?

The Merkle Business Architecture & Go-to-Market Sharepoint includes a video walk through of the Future-Ready Technology presentation, as well as a written talk track.

Visit the SharePoint also has all materials related to our go-to-market, including toolkits, corporate case templates, and other presentation materials. The SharePoint is regularly updated.

When was this file last updated?

May, 2025

This document will regularly be updated with improved and new materials.

To make sure you have the latest version, check the Business Architecture & Go-to-Market Sharepoint.

WHAT'S INSIDE

CRM & Messaging Sales Story

Offering Definition

Sales Enablement

About Merkle's 2024 GTM



a dentsu company

CRM & Messaging

These slides are ready for client presentation.

The next section of this deck includes links to a talk track and other enablement materials

Messaging is at the center of the Experience Gap

80%

Of companies believe they deliver “superior experiences”

EXPERIENCE
GAP

8% of consumers agree



Inconsistent cross-platform experience



Overwhelming number of promotions



Messages that lack context

“ By 2026 there will be almost 400B emails sent every day and 82% will go unopened. ”

- Statista November 2022



Source: <https://media.bain.com/bainweb/PDFs/cms/hotTopics/closingdeliverygap.pdf>
Timkin Research State of Experience 2022

a dentsu company

Messaging is at the center of the Experience Economy

- ✓ Facilitates real-time connections between consumers and businesses.
- ✓ Serves as the tip of the spear for personalization at scale.
- ✓ Extends authentic brand value proposition.
- ✓ Most efficient way to maximize ROI and cultivate CLV.



a dentsu company



Today's consumers demand more from messaging.

Meet me where I am and make it easy for me.

Show me that you know me, every time.

Make me a valued part of your brand.

Keep up with me! Help meet my goals.

MANY BRANDS STILL STRUGGLE WITH PERSONALIZATION...

76%

Are frustrated companies they work with doesn't personalize.

26%

Of marketers are confident that their organization has a successful strategy for personalization

...AND THE OMNI-CHANNEL CHALLENGE IS GROWING

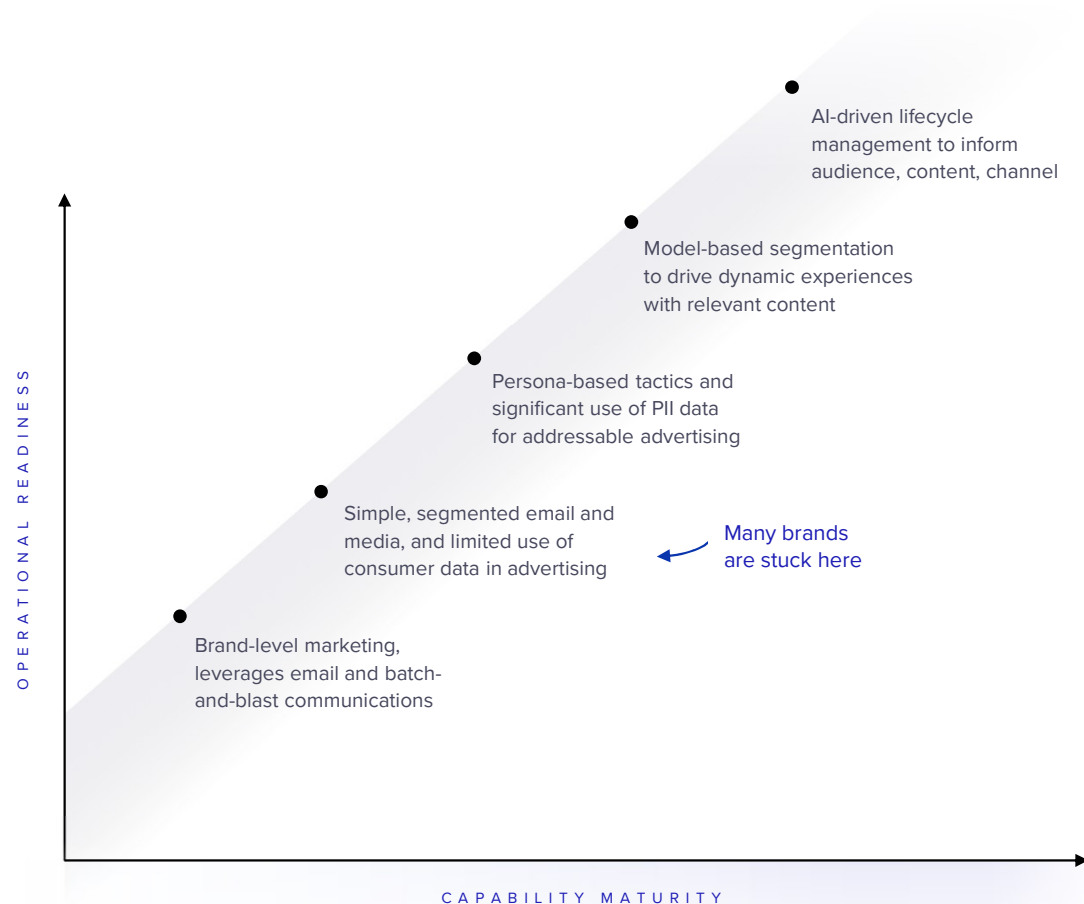
90%

Of consumers want brands to interact with them in preferred channels—SMS, social media, or chat apps.

50M

Number of consumer messages on Meta platforms that go unanswered by businesses every day.

Many brands do not have the operational expertise needed to advance their messaging capability.



Where brands struggle



Fragmented ownership of customer experience



Disconnected, dated, or redundant technology



Lack of organizational alignment



Issues with data quality, recency, or readiness



Poor or outdated processes



Finding the right messaging mix



Driving innovation while delivering BAU



Lack of resource bandwidth



Lack of knowledge and skill set



Creating and delivering enough content to scale with automation

**Technology is transforming messaging,
enabling brands to identify, connect,
and converse with consumers in ways
that were once unimaginable.**

ENABLING BRANDS TO:

Anticipate consumer needs and help them meet their goals

Create an always on **contextually relevant conversation**

Balance rational and emotional to appeal to the head and the heart

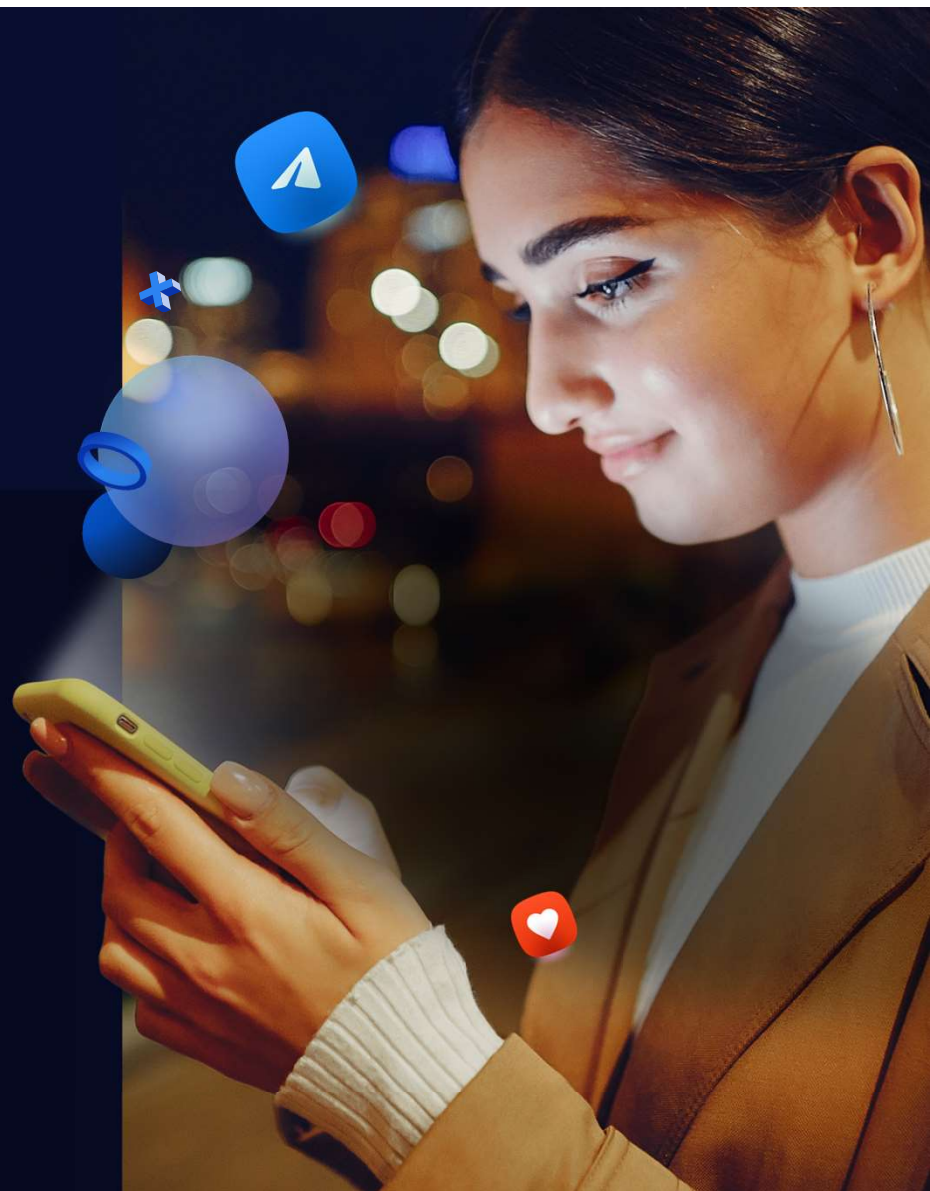
Create moments of value at key inflection points in the journey

CHANNELS:

EMAIL	INSTAGRAM	MMS	SMS	PUSH	FACEBOOK
ON-SITE	CHATBOTS	IN-APP	WHAT'S APP		



a **dentsu** company



Brands who can leverage these advances will effectively influence buying behavior across the customer lifecycle

Likelihood to purchase, recommend, and repurchase depending on personalization

78%

Are more likely to recommend

76%

Are more likely to consider purchase

78%

Are more likely to repurchase

Sources: PR Newswire – New retail study shows marketers under leverage emotional connection! Forbes.com - How To Overcome Technology's Artificial Divide And Succeed At Being Seamless | CMO by Adobe – Mind Blowing Stats about Customer Experience Management; Gartner: Realizing the Benefits of a Superior Customer Experience – May 2018



a dentsu company

CRM TRANSFORMATION

Merkle can help you create a path to messaging transformation



Provide a path to value

that prioritizes your brands needs based on business impact and level of complexity



Map customer interactions

for all current and future state touchpoints across your customer journey



Create better experiences

from brand to demand, we will develop distinct messaging and design strategies required at phase of the journey



Maximize your investment

by better leveraging your marketing technology and optimizing the use of your full technology stack

Moving your messaging from siloed campaigns to connected conversations



CAMPAIGNS



CONVERSATIONS

from siloed



connected

from transactional



contextual

from mass



moments

from execution



outcomes



a dentsu company

**Activating messaging as
part of a connected
experience ecosystem.**





Renewing support for important causes

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Reconnect Salvation Army donors to the issues of Food Insecurity and Anti-Human Trafficking. Their extensive Food and Anti-Human Trafficking programs have seen declining support through the email channel over the last few years.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Delivered a story-telling approach that focuses on building human connections through the use of emotions. Refocused the messaging to spotlight the greater needs under both Food Insecurity and Anti-Human Trafficking by shifting away from program education.

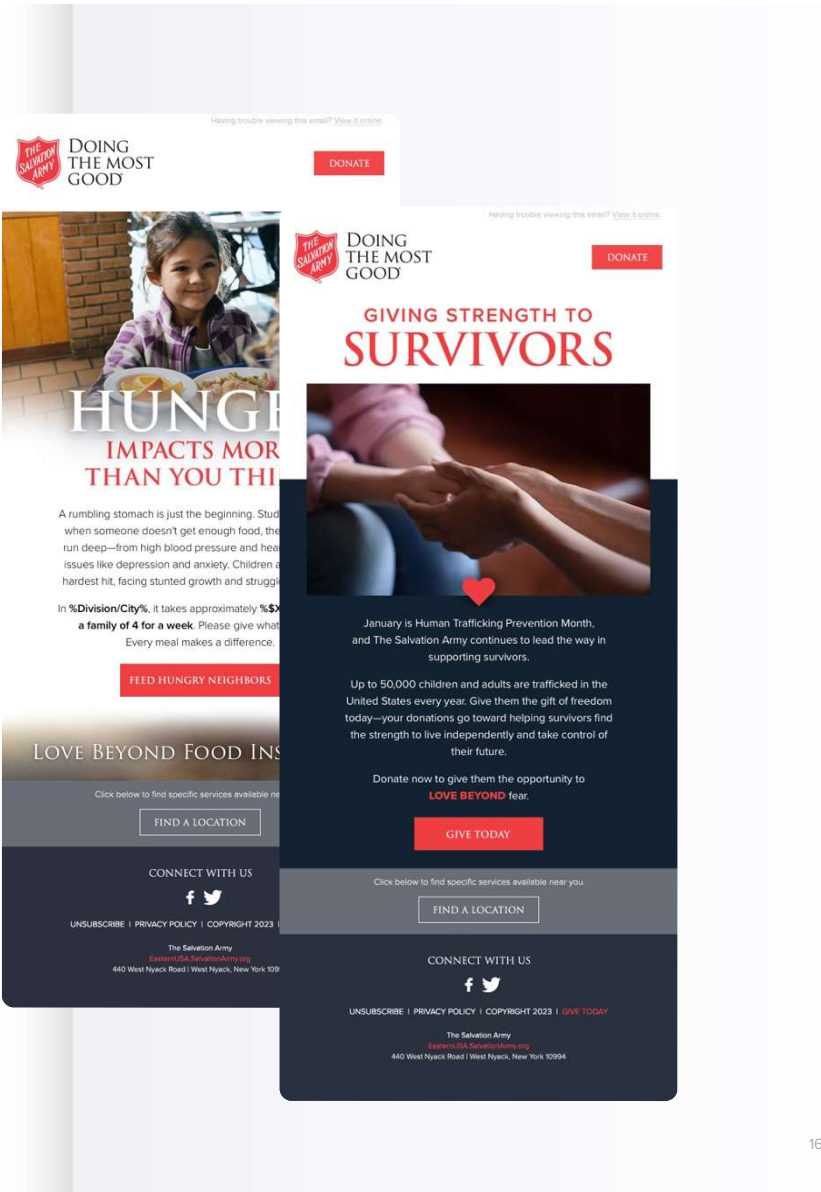
FINAL CAMPAIGN PERFORMANCE

Ending Food Insecurity

Email open rates	Revenue
increased by 13%	increased by 3%

Ending Human trafficking

Email open rates	Revenue
increased by 26%	increased by 38%





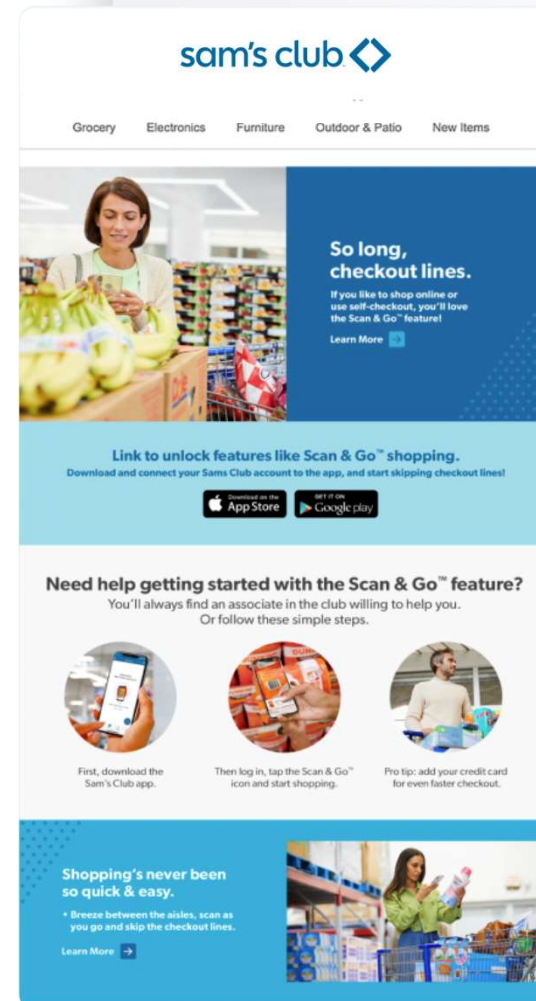
Connected Experiences

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Merkle helped Sam's Club migrate to Salesforce Marketing Cloud, then partnered with them to move beyond messaging to focus on evolving the member experience, online and in the warehouse.

MERKLE SOLUTION

- Maximized the potential their tech stack by allowing building and innovating connected consumer strategies.
- Laid a framework of multiple interconnected, personalized journeys and triggers centered around actions members can take that have the highest propensity increase their likelihood to renew.
- Built strategies centered around four primary actions to drive behavior based on signals in their database tied to each member.
- The work pushed their capabilities forward and, at the same time, freed their product leaders to focus on long term business objectives.



Neutrogena®

Ring in the Holidays

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Merkle manages both email and web initiatives for Neutrogena. Over the holidays, we implemented their exclusive Holiday Shop while driving strategies to raise consumer awareness and revenue.

MERKLE SOLUTION

- Holiday Shop launch including gift guide and exclusive holiday sets
- Reimagined email strategy to drive traffic to the Shop

56% YoY

Increase in revenue

50% YoY

Increase in web traffic

16.8%

Email Conversion rate more than 6% increase from previous year

Neutrogena®
#1 DERMATOLOGIST RECOMMENDED

ifw
IFUNDWOMEN

INTRODUCING
THE IFUNDWOMEN X
NEUTROGENA FUND

We are teaming up with IfundWomen to give women-owned businesses in the health and wellness space a fresh start in 2021.

LEARN MORE

YOU SAVE \$1,
WE CONTRIBUTE \$1
ON NEUTROGENA® WIPES
PURCHASES*

From 3/28 to 4/17, Neutrogena® is offering a \$1 off promotion on wipes* across Coupons.com, participating retailer platforms and neutrogena.com. Additionally, for each coupon redeemed, we will contribute \$1 to IfundWomen to support women-owned businesses.

*Excludes Trial & Travel and Pink Champagne. A minimum contribution of \$10,000 will be made. IfundWomen is a for-profit company, not a charity.

SHOP NOW

GET
RETAIL
COUPON

CLEAN SKIN IN ONE SIMPLE STEP

Welcome to the family – we're so happy to have you with us! You'll be the first to hear about new products and promos. And you'll get helpful tips and more to achieve your healthiest skin yet.

ENJOY 15% OFF
YOUR FIRST ORDER

USE CODE: WELCOME15

SHOP NOW

Offering Definition

This content outlines the various packages you can sell within this offering. The first is a wedge, or door opener, priced to help get the the first sale.

The rest are engagements that fit various needs related to the offering. Put one or a few in front of your client, based on their needs.

Messaging Tech Assessment

WEDGE



Messaging Tech Assessment

Understand how your brands communications compares to best-in-class benchmarks with Merkle's messaging strategy assessment.

Helping clients understand where they are today; address technology gaps and pain points; Build a strategic technology roadmap; and make informed technology purchases

THIS ASSESSMENT WILL INCLUDE

- ✓ Assessment, Recommendations, and Roadmap for a single capability, such as Email, Content, Data, Identity, etc.
- ✓ Quick wins to enable tech in a specific area



MESSAGING TECH

ASSESSMENT

Assess the current state of Digital Messaging technology, understand business objectives, and identify opportunities to increase efficiency and maximize customer engagement

Description and Activities

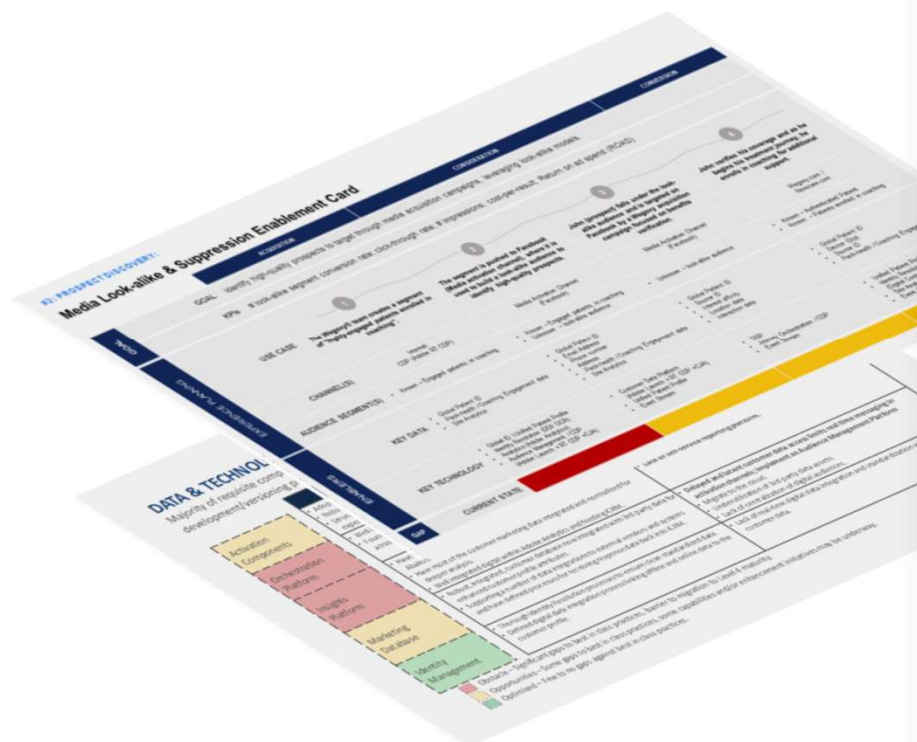
- Understand digital messaging technology and goals
- Review data flows and user stories, and program execution approach
- Conduct interviews with stakeholders and key platform users
- Identify efficiencies, customer engagement gaps and future state opportunities

Values

- Critical integration and operating gaps illuminated
- Consolidated view of customer experience
- Gaps & opportunities identified
- Foundation for solution recommendations

ASSESSMENT

Assess the current state of Digital Messaging technology, understand business objectives, and identify opportunities to increase efficiency and maximize customer engagement



OUTPUTS

- Assessment and Gap Analysis

MESSAGING TECH ASSESSMENT

RECOMMENDATIONS

Create specific, actionable technology recommendations to close identified gaps, optimize use of the technology, increase customer engagement and achieve desired future state

Description and Activities

- Recommend specific solution initiatives to achieve future state
- Visualize a future state blueprint of Digital Messaging program
- Provide a detailed overview, customer impact and prioritization for each recommendation

Values

- Actionable recommendations focused on improved customer experience & ROI
- Clear view of future state with Merkle POV
- Merkle will provide best practices for CX & digital messaging technologies based on their position as an industry leader in these two areas.

MESSAGING TECH ASSESSMENT

RECOMMENDATIONS

Create specific, actionable technology recommendations to close identified gaps, optimize use of the technology, increase customer engagement and achieve desired future state



OUTPUTS

- Prioritized Recommendations
- Future State Logical Architecture

MESSAGING TECH ASSESSMENT

ACTION PLAN

Actualize a high-level plan of sequenced initiatives and activities, designed to achieve the future state vision

Description and Activities

- Recommendations and requirements placed into sequenced year by year or month by month plan
- Phased by impact, effort, dependencies
- Investment requirements

Values

- Actionable fully timed plan
- Digital Messaging technology and integrations linked to customer experience and business outcomes
- Foresight into solution investment and integrations required
- Tested and phased for minimal disruption and seamless implementation/adoption

ACTION PLAN

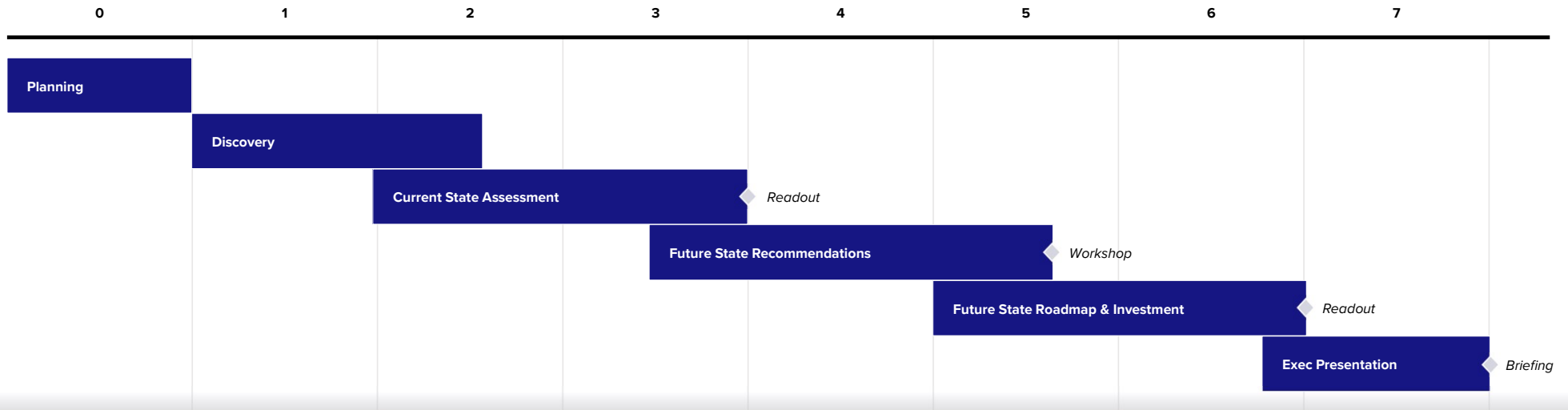
Actualize a high-level plan of sequenced initiatives and activities, designed to achieve the future state vision



OUTPUTS

- Sequenced Plan
- Executive Summary

Typical 6-Week Engagement Timeline



Planning

- Stakeholder Prep
- Scheduling and Logistics

Discovery

- Stakeholder Interviews and Workshops
- Document Collection & Discussion
- Functional Roadmap Requirements

Current State Assessment

- Current State Evaluation and Implications
- Current State Ecosystem Documentation
- Maturity Assessment

Future State Recommendations

- Tech Stack Recommendations
- Future State Technology Blueprint

Future State Roadmap & Investment

- Sequenced Multi-year Roadmap
- Technology Investment and Operating Estimates

Exec Presentation

- Executive Reviews & Final Roadmap Presentation
- Solution Discussions

Project Pricing

Pricing	Timeline	Total Interviews	Channels & Systems	Workshops
\$80k - \$100k Includes current state assessment, recommendations, logical architecture, action plan or use cases	6-8 Weeks Planning and scheduling will happen in week 0 before kickoff	Up to 10 Including all follow-up discussions	Up to 5 Included as part of stakeholder interviews and discussions	Up to 2 Key meetings and readouts

- All on site work sessions time and location will be scheduled ahead of time
- SME's will be pulled in as necessary based on need (not included)
- Pricing doesn't include Travel and expense costs, est. to be 15% of total cost
- Any additional items or tasks may need to be assessed, scoped and may require additional costs

Slide 29

NB1

[@Katherine Jones-Siemsen] let's mark this pricing and scope slide internal; the rest of the slides in this section 22-31 can be client-facing/external.

Nicole Burgess, 2024-01-24T15:52:34.765

MARTECH COMPANY

Marketing technology & email platform assessment

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Client's Management challenged the organization to enable one-to-one communications while understanding complex customer journeys at an individual level. The goal was to become "Customer First" oriented and to develop a future state and plan for evolving the marketing planning and execution platforms to enable "Customer First" strategies whenever a customer encountered the Brand's touchpoints. The key challenge was multiple inefficient and disconnected Email platforms creating a barrier to achieving broader business objectives of understanding the customer and engaging with personalized messaging.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle conducted an overall MarTech assessment, delivered recommendations, and created a future state roadmap. The primary focus of the engagement was to assess existing Email platforms and execution as well as determining how to achieve a best-in-class future state. The team leveraged internal Eloqua, Responsys, and Adobe SMEs to provide in-depth knowledge and neutrality for the decision-making process.

IMPACT

Client updated existing ecosystem roadmap to become the basis for their Business Architecture Transformation Strategy

Customer initiated Platform consolidation and upgrades specific to selected Email platforms



Messaging Strategy Assessment

WEDGE



Messaging Strategy Assessment

Merkle's CRM Strategy Assessment underlines our commitment to measurable business impact. We combine thoughtful, data-driven optimizations, years of applied experience, and a passion for results to go beyond just recommendations – we set the foundation for a true partnership in which we succeed together.

A Focus on Measurable Outcomes

Increased Engagement

Customer engagement is critical to drive revenue - and consumers expect it from brands more and more. Our Messaging Strategy Assessment will uncover opportunities to maximize consumer engagement.

Greater Purchase Frequency

What's keeping your consumer base from buying more often? We'll dive into your messaging performance to identify opportunities to keep bringing purchasers back.

Messaging Strategy Assessment

Understand how your brands communications compares to best-in-class benchmarks with Merkle's messaging strategy assessment.

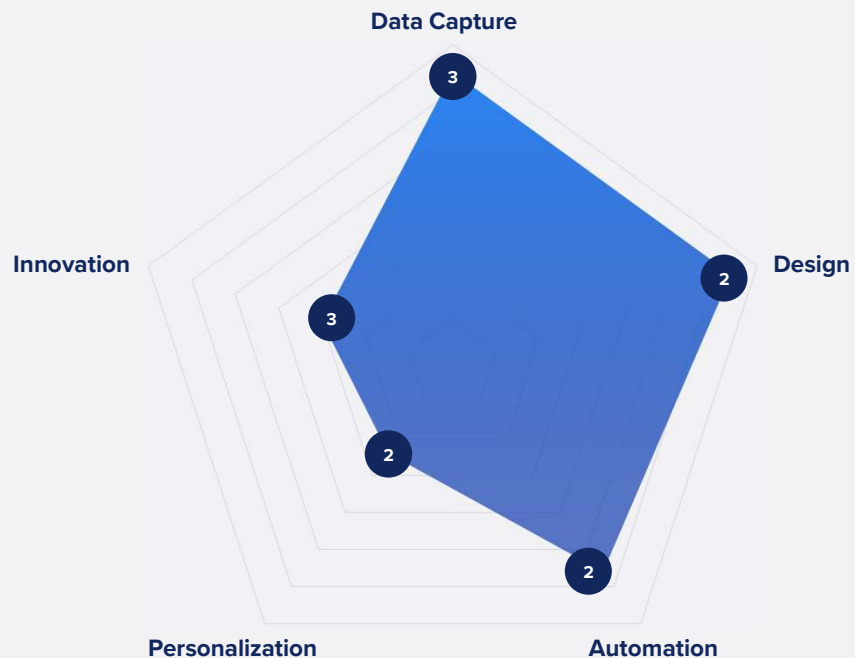
Merkle's Messaging Assessment helps brands create more connected journeys for customers through a deep understanding of messaging strategy and innovative creative combined with data strategy and technology enablement.

THIS ASSESSMENT WILL INCLUDE

- ✓ Current state assessment of your messaging program, with an intentional focus on 1-2 active messaging channels
- ✓ Comparison to best-in-class benchmarks within your industry.
- ✓ High level recommendations based on the opportunity gaps uncovered



Key Messaging Dimensions



1 – Worst in Class

5 – Best in Class

DIMENSION

KEY INSIGHTS

Creative

Do the communications create engagement with a professional, innovative and brand-connected design?

Data Capture

Once engaged, how well does the brand capture relevant and actionable data?

Automation

How effective is the brand at providing automated or real-time communications?

Personalization

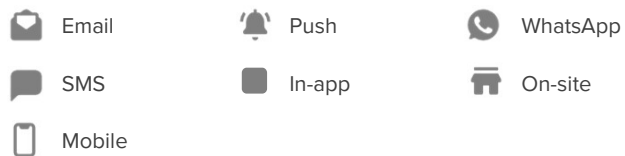
To what level is personalization incorporated into the communications?

Innovation

To what degree is the brand creating new experiences or using CRM best practices?

We Will Access The Orchestration of All Messages in the selected channel(s)

Channels may include:

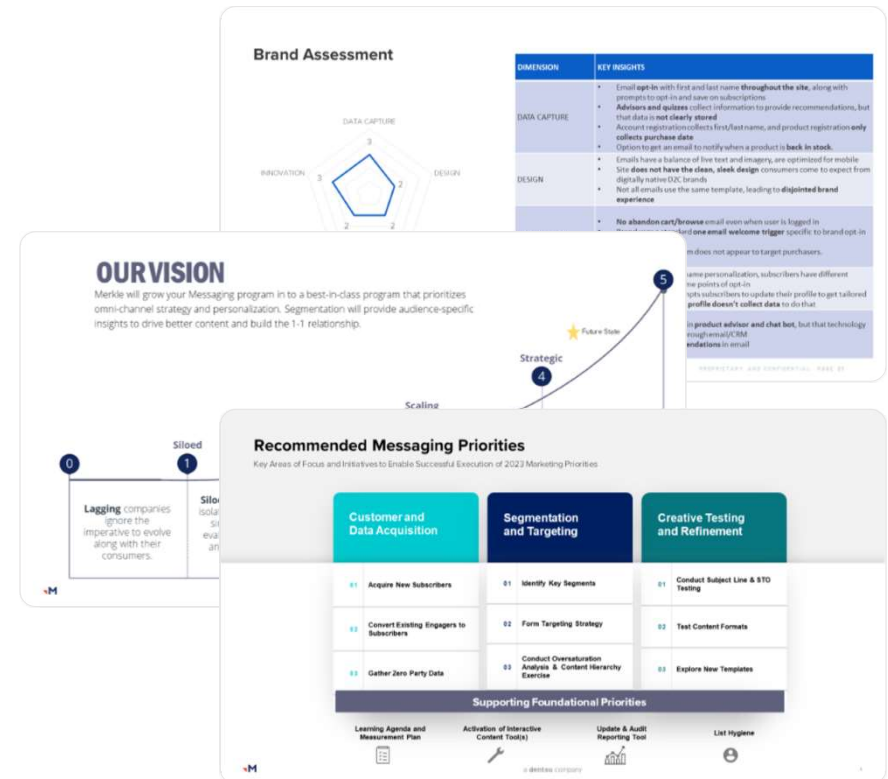


We Deliver Actionable Recommendations

Merkle will work with your team to understand the key KPIs and current metric benchmarks to evaluate potential for incremental revenue.

We focus on recommendations to:

- ✓ Improve Customer & Data Acquisition
- ✓ Increase retention and engagement
- ✓ Drive incremental revenue and CLV
- ✓ Test & Refine Creative
- ✓ Orchestrate personalization at scale



EXAMPLE DELIVERABLES

Messaging Assessment

Current State Assessment of client's messaging, with a focus on a key channel, in comparison to industry best-in-class

High-level recommendations based on opportunity gap present between current and future state.

INCLUDES

- Data capture
- Engagement
- Creative
- Innovation
- Personalization

Investment: \$50k-75k

Timing: 6-7 Weeks

Outcomes:

- Kickoff meeting
- Desk research& artifact research
- Competitive market scan
- Current state messaging assessment
- Gap analysis & recommendations

MESSAGING STRATEGY ASSESSMENT

PRICE	\$50K-\$75K
DURATION	6-7 weeks
# OF CHANNELS	1-2
# OF BRANDS	1

ACTIVITY

Kickoff Meeting	X
Desk Research and Artifact Review	X
Competitive Market Scan (# of competitors)	Up to 3
Current State Messaging Assessment (5 dimensions)	X
Gap Analysis & Recommendations	X

*cost to be determined based on final scope

We can augment a Messaging Strategy Assessment (email focus selected) with an SFMC Feature Audit

Our marketing team with platform expertise will examine your brands current usage on the SFMC platform.

WE WILL FOCUS ON RECOMMENDATIONS TO:

- Identify opportunities to more fully utilize the platform
- These recommendations can ultimately be built into new journeys, test plans, and more.

STRATEGIC ASSESSMENT OF MATTRESS FIRM'S USE OF SFMC FEATURES

Rating Based on # of Journeys applied to 5+ 1-4 0

Opportunity to expand use of SFMC features for cohesive experience

TOPIC	RATING	INSIGHT
Is Journey Builder being leveraged for a significant portion of multi-step and/or single-step campaigns?	5+	All multi-step and single email campaigns are running in Journey Builder
Is a healthy mix of always on and one-time journeys present?	5+	Numerous always on journeys present alongside one-time day to day emails
Are there a healthy amount of automations present and running to transform and normalize data and simplify execution tasks?	5+	Numerous automations set up and active in Automation Studio
Is Einstein STO being used?	1-4	STO being used in Reengagement and Abandoned Browse Search campaigns
Is Einstein Engagement Frequency being used?	0	Not currently utilizing Engagement Frequency
Is Einstein Copy or Message Insights being used?	5+	Copy and Message Insights are activated
Are Engagement decisions being used in Journeys or segmentation?	1-4	Non-engagers sent follow up email in Reengagement Series
Are there touchpoints live throughout the customer lifecycle journey?	5+	Email are present across the entire customer lifecycle journey with opportunity to go deeper
Are decision splits being used in Journeys?	5+	Non-Purchasers in Mattress Matcher Journey, Abandoned Browse & Cart, Non-Engagers in Reengagement Journey
Is segmentation being leveraged in Journeys?	0	No segmentation currently being used
Is there A/B creative testing being done?	5+	A/B(C) testing being used across numerous journeys
Is the account well organized to easily maintain live programs?	0	Several paused and stopped automations should be assessed for deprecation. No standard naming conventions in the account make it difficult to search account.
Is SMS incorporated into Journeys?	0	Mobile Studio is available in SFMC, but not currently being leveraged
Is Ad Studio being leveraged for retargeting?	0	Ad Studio is available in SFMC, but not currently being leveraged

 a dentsu company

SFMC ADD-ON

1-2 ADDITIONAL WEEKS

\$15K COST

CRM Strategy Blueprint

PACKAGED ENGAGEMENT



CRM Strategy Blueprint

Uncover opportunities to deliver more relevant customer communications that drive engagement and conversion

Using our collaborative approach, Blueprints deliver a comprehensive assessment & strategy, complete with a roadmap and prioritized opportunities.

THIS ASSESSMENT WILL INCLUDE

- ✓ **Diagnose gaps & opportunities:** For current and future state touchpoints across your customer journey
- ✓ **Deliver a Path To Value:** That prioritizes business opportunities based on business impact and level of complexity
- ✓ **Map Interactions:** for all current and future state touchpoints across your customer journey
- ✓ **Maximize Your Investment:** By better leveraging your marketing technology and optimizing the use of your full technology stack



Process and Deliverables

Leverage our team of experts and our customer-centered framework. We will create an actionable plan to drive your business forward by focusing on how to best engage your customers in actions.

CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIP MARKETING OPPORTUNITY

- Lead brand discovery that includes 1:1 stakeholder interviews
- Summarize the competitive assessment
- Audit existing assets to surface gaps and opportunities
- Create an insights-driven relationship marketing opportunity to build the plan from

STRATEGIC PLAN

- Define key goals and KPIs
- Draft a strategic plan, used to direct solution design, that outlines the vision, strategies, execution initiatives, and success measures
- Journey mapping for programs that build the customer experience foundation
- Establish prioritization framework

STRATEGIC APPROACH AND DESIGN

- Develop tactical and structural solutions to take advantage of the relationship marketing opportunity
- Summarize recommendations in the optimized customer experience

REQUIREMENTS AND ROADMAP

- Develop a measurement plan, with benchmarks, to define requirements for performance measurement
- Develop recommendation for ongoing program management and maintenance
- Scope the recommendations and time to market ranges aligned to the specific idea, budget, and timing

Blueprint package comparison

		STANDARD
PACKAGE	Price	\$150K-\$200K
	Timeframe	10-12 weeks
	# Of Channels	Up to 2
	# of Brands	Up to 3
ACTIVITY	Kickoff Meeting	✓
	Desk Research and Artifact Review	✓
	Stakeholder Interviews	Up to 4
	Competitive Market Scan (# of competitors)	Up to 6 competitors
	Current State Messaging Assessment (5 dimensions)	✓
	Gap Analysis & Recommendations	✓
	Strategic Plan and KPIs	✓
	Prioritization Framework	✓
	12-18 Month Roadmap	✓
	Journey Maps for Recommended Strategies	Up to 6
	Measurement Plan and Benchmarking	✓
ENHANCEMENT	Current State Customer Journey Illustration	
	Audience Insights powered by Merkury	
	Data Hygiene and Performance Assessment Audit	
	Customer Survey	
	Business Case Workshop	
	Tactics Structure and Design	
	Business Case	
	Program Requirements	
	Sample Designs for Messages in Recommended Journeys	

Messaging Platform Implementation, Migration and Managed Services

PACKAGED ENGAGEMENT



ESP (Messaging Platform) Migration or Implementation

Professional services offering to aid clients in their transition from one ESP technology to another—including setup/configuration of the new platform, migration of assets from the old platform to the new one (including content, data, campaign logic, certain integrations, etc.), IP warming, and go-live.

Using our collaborative approach, we'll use consulting approach / platform knowledge – especially related to Salesforce, Adobe, Braze, and Oracle, as well as Email Deliverability services.

THIS ASSESSMENT WILL INCLUDE

- ✓ Improved customer experiences (enables more relevant, targeted, and automated non-linear, multi-channel content)
- ✓ Improved mechanism to drive growth (revenue/margin, known customers, acquisition, AOV, etc.)
- ✓ Optimization / Efficiency (operational, cost or time to serve/operate, reduced technical debt)
- ✓ Risk management (validates platform or tech against a use case, modernizes stack)



a dentsu company



WHAT YOU SHOULD KNOW

We're your go-to partner for Messaging



We've been doing this a long time

We're experts in the Messaging space and have been a part of Merkle for almost 20 years, evolving into a cross-platform group in 2011 and **growing from \$8MM+ in annual revenue in 2014 to over \$61MM in 2023 (663% growth).**



We believe in a connected ecosystem

Messaging—and particularly email—is just one component of the larger customer experience, so we look at everything through the lens of **Messaging's relationship to—and impact on—things like creative, strategy, loyalty, media, social, analytics, etc.**



We know all of the major Messaging platforms

We have **established practices in the Salesforce, Adobe, Oracle, and Braze ecosystems**, and are looking to expand into new platforms like **Iterable** and **Bloomreach**. This means that we're not often tied to a client's existing platform—we can grow with the client and **remain their partner no matter which technology they choose in the future.**



We have our finger on the industry's pulse

We're up to speed on the rapidly changing capabilities, trends, and technologies in the industry and advise clients on how to best approach them. **Not every rabbit hole is worth diving down**—we don't want to be a solution in search of a problem, but rather want to demonstrate to clients how these new developments in the market can **help them solve real challenges and generate meaningful strategic outcomes.**



We're really, *really* good at what we do

Our 250+ experts have numerous certifications across major messaging platforms, deliver 20B+ emails annually across nearly 29,000 campaigns, and perform their work at an incredibly high level—**our accuracy rate across all campaigns is 99.7% and has been 100% during Black Friday/Cyber Monday for four of the past five years (including in 2023).**



CRM TRANSFORMATION

Merkle can help you create a path to messaging transformation



Provide a path to value

that prioritizes your brands needs based on business impact and level of complexity



Map customer interactions

for all current and future state touchpoints across your customer journey



Create better experiences

from brand to demand, we will develop distinct messaging and design strategies required at phase of the journey



Maximize your investment

by better leveraging your marketing technology and optimizing the use of your full technology stack

Moving your messaging from siloed campaigns to connected conversations



CAMPAIGNS



CONVERSATIONS

from siloed



connected

from transactional



contextual

from mass



moments

from execution



outcomes



a dentsu company

We are preferred partners with the world's leading CRM technologies

- Braze**
Global Strategic Partner – Alloy Partner Program
- Adobe**
#1 in Global Adobe Product Specializations
- Salesforce**
#1 Global Agency Partner



CORE MESSAGING PLATFORMS



MESSAGING ALLIANCES

CREATIVE AUTOMATION 	DYNAMIC CREATIVE OPTIMIZATION 	MODULAR/DYNAMIC EMAIL
LOYALTY 	DATA / ANALYTICS / ML 	GENERATIVE AI

1 [@Lauren Pietersen]

Updates Complete:

Replaced Yotpo logo with Talon.One logo. Replace Clutch logo with Airship logo.

Kimberly Fisher, 2026-01-16T18:41:39.103

Three steps to a successful implementation

DISCOVERY

A robust discovery lays the foundation for thoughtful and solid implementation. Spending meaningful time here will ensure we get it right—and map out configuration and implementation in a way that makes sense for you and your budget

CONFIGURATION & INTEGRATION

Configuration and integration will be crucial to ensure we hit the ground running. This is a great time to imagine your consumer experience and use cases and make sure your technology can support it in a way that reduces technical debt and increases engagement

IMPLEMENTATION

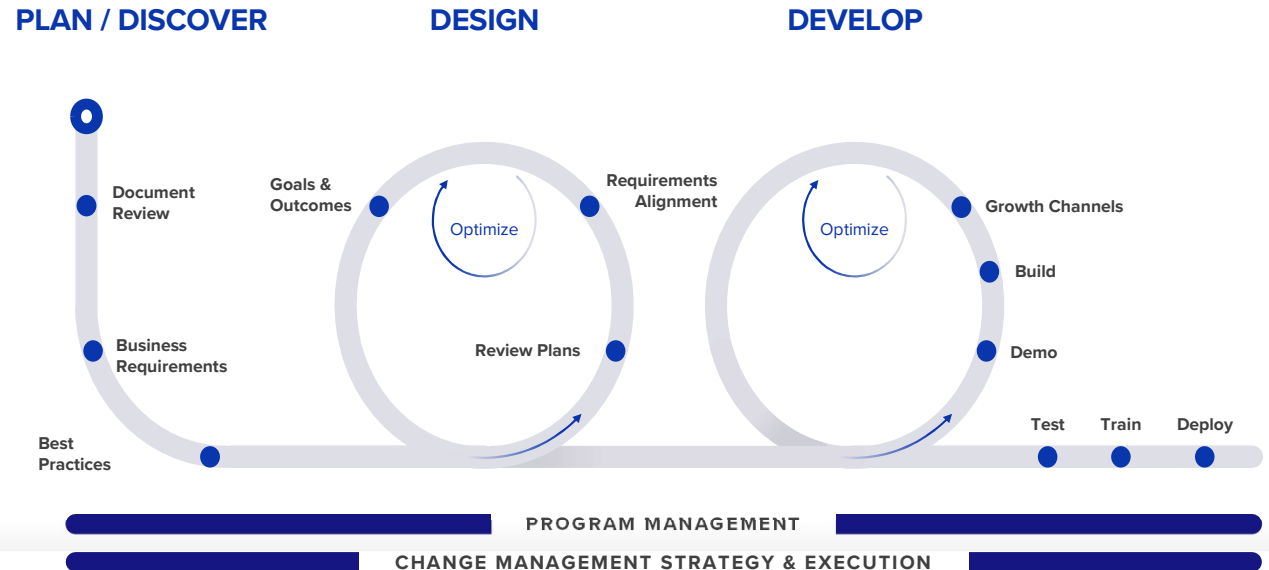
Merkle has implemented hundreds of marketing automation platforms for our clients. Our proven implementation methodology keeps a keen eye on detail and quality, allowing us to deliver much more than “just a platform”

OUR STRATEGIC APPROACH TO

Modernizing & Optimizing ESPs

Merkle will transform clients' current ESP capabilities to better leverage more modern marketing capabilities to drive more meaningful engagement across your digital activation channels.

Merkle has helped numerous clients to re-architect and optimize existing capabilities to create new, more modern, and better-integrated solutions. In addition to reworking the data model, there's a lot that can be done within ESP that will enable more efficient coordination between national and local teams with better distribution and availability of content, data, audiences, and feature sets.



We'll do this by:

Understanding clients' marketing strategies, use cases, campaign requirements, and KPIs to drive the design and optimization of their digital messaging programs.

Articulating the current- and future-state for campaigns, technologies, and marketing goals.

Leveraging data to deliver the right content to the right audience at the right time—at scale and across geographies.

Translating and transforming existing campaigns into orchestrated, cross-channel customer experiences driven by performance creative principles.

Creating and fostering an environment built around continued testing, learning, measurement, optimization, and improvement.



a dentsu company

Truly evolving your members' experiences requires “always on” optimization, driven by planning, testing, and insights

REPORTING & ANALYTICS

- Insight Generation
- Measurement Strategy
- Automated Reports
- Campaign Deep Dives
- Model Development/ Enhancements
- Campaign Reporting
- Test Cell Analysis

CAMPAIGN EXECUTION

- Data Integration
- Audience Targeting
- Audience Scoring and Selection
- Exclusion Criteria
- Holdout preservation
- Quality Control
- Offer Deployment



PLANNING

- Strategic Roadmap
- Competitor & Industry Research
- Program Goals
- Prior Results/Findings Review
- Ideation
- Audience Profiling and Sizing
- Forecasting

CAMPAIGN DESIGN

- Audience Planning
- Creative and Messaging Alignment
- Offer Design
- Loyalty Integration
- Contact Governance
- Frequency Planning
- Test Matrix Design

ANALYTICS

STRATEGY

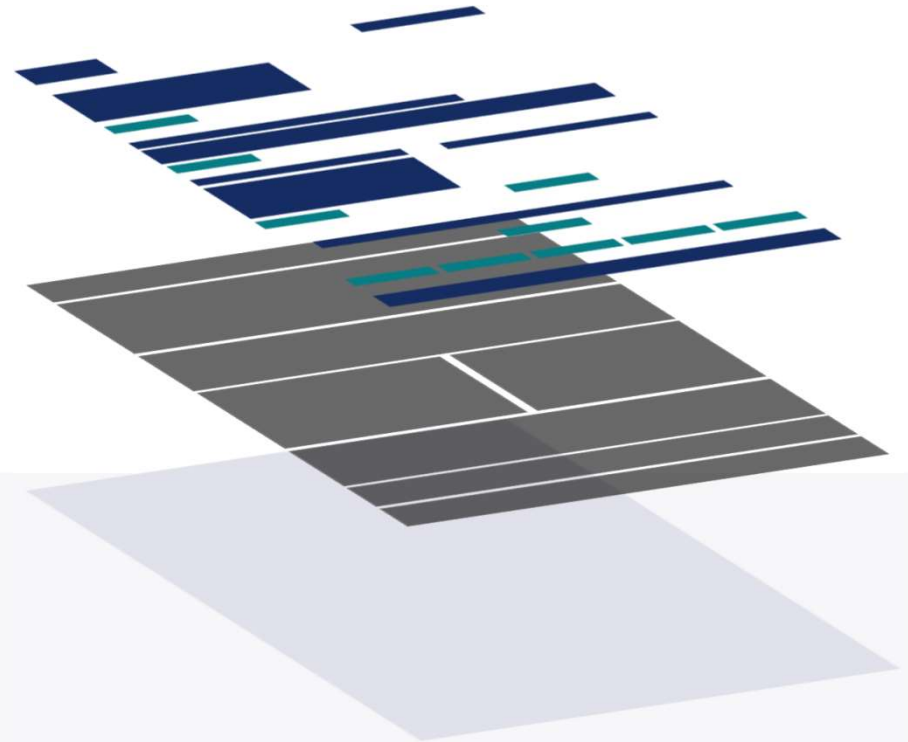
Our processes are designed to help our clients keep pace with optimization

Merkle's expertise in highly-dynamic, data-driven templates enables targeted, relevant messaging based on where your members are in their unique journeys. This allows us to build, test, optimize, and deploy campaigns at a much faster pace than our competition.

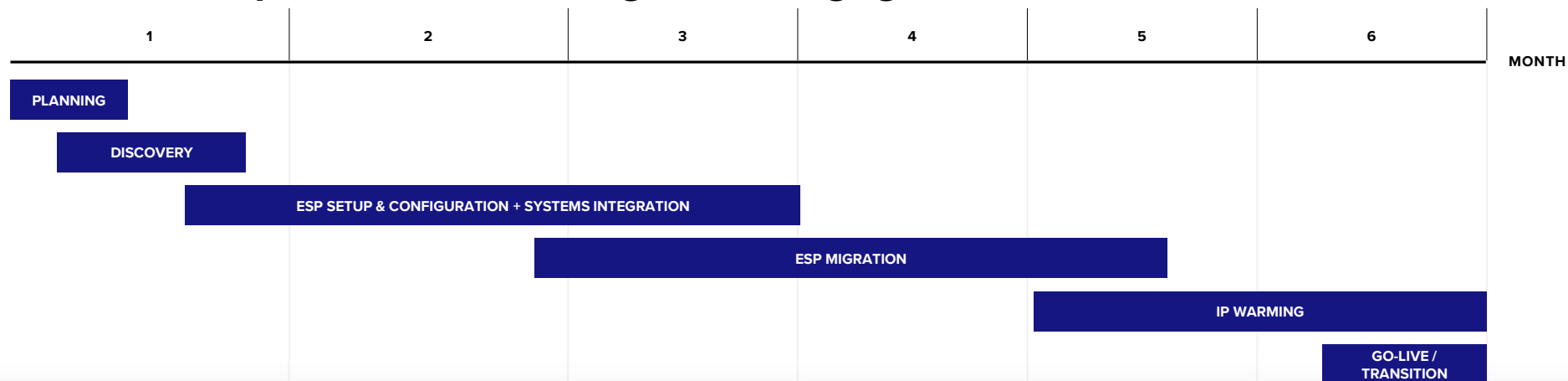
- Faster turnaround of new builds
- Streamlined submission & expedited approval processes
- More consistent branding continuity
- Reduced content & compliance errors
- More scale across teams, geographies, and channels

MERKLE SUPPORTS MULTIPLE OPERATING MODELS:

- 1 Build templates and content blocks within the ESP
- 2 Implement tools (e.g., Taxi, Stensul, etc.) that integrate with the marketing platform and give marketers more flexibility through less reliance on technical resources



Timeline: Implementation & Migration Engagement



PLANNING

- Establish ways of working, key points of contact, RACI, etc.
- Establish comms plan
- Define KPIs and strategy

DISCOVERY

- Stakeholder interviews to learn client's current state, including technology integrations, etc.
- Determine migration priorities
- Full existing campaign assessment
- Determine key points of integration & data needs

ESP SETUP & CONFIGURATION

- Set up and configure the ESP
- Build email templates (standard, code red, etc.) and workflows
- Begin integrations from external systems into ESP (e.g., API, webhooks, tracking, etc.)
- Testing/QA

ESP MIGRATION

- Begin campaign and data migration, by previously agreed prioritization exercise
- Build and implement IP warming plan
- Initial ad hoc campaign + preference builds
- Testing/QA

IP WARMING

- Begin IP warming on all promotional IP addresses in ESP
- Monitoring/reporting
- Optimization as needed

TRANSITION TO MANAGED SERVICES

- Prepare for go-live transition
- Review implementation
- Identify areas of optimization
- Complete onboarding managed services team
- Documentation
- Testing/QA

Pricing: Implementation & Migration Engagement

		OPTIMIZE (EXISTING)	IMPLEMENT	IMPLEMENT + MIGRATE	Managed Services
ENGAGEMENT MODEL	Description	Optimize existing ESP	Implement a new ESP	Implement new ESP and migrate assets from old ESP	Ongoing managed services on behave of client team
	Client Engagement	Focus on reconfiguring and optimizing existing ESP setup, including select campaigns and data models	Focus on standing up a new ESP, including platform configuration, priority campaign builds, light integration with third-party tools, testing, and IP warming	See previous offering, with the addition of fully migrating existing campaigns and data from the old ESP and doing more complex third-party integrations, API calls, multi-channel builds, etc.	We offer various managed services including full-service, hybrid/partial-service, and staff augmentation to help clients delivery on their CRM technology
	Collaboration	Discovery, demo, workshops (as needed), process optimization	Discovery, builds, data modeling, train the trainer, testing/proofing, etc.	Discovery, builds, data modeling, train the trainer, testing/proofing, etc.	Transition, onboarding, ways of working and discovery sessions to take over deployment.
	Deliverables:	1. Config specs 2. Data model (if changed) 3. Process docs / SOPs	1. Live ESP 2. SSL certificates (w/ client) 3. Config specs 4. Data model 5. Process docs / SOPs 6. IP warming plan + readout 7. Train the trainer plan + sessions	1. Live ESP 2. SSL certificates (w/ client) 3. Config specs 4. Data model 5. Process docs / SOPs 6. IP warming plan + readout 7. Transition plan from old ESP 8. Train the trainer plan + sessions	1. Process development 2. RACI and ways of working 3. HTML/Messaging creative production timeline review 4. Build and evaluation of content for deployment 5. Deployment activities 6. Thought leadership and industry insights 7. Continuous platform optimization
SCOPE	Resources	Platform Architect Platform Developer HTML Developer Campaign Specialists	Platform Architect Platform Developer HTML Developer Campaign Specialists Deliverability Specialist	Platform Architect Platform Developer HTML Developer Campaign Specialists Deliverability Specialist	CRM Manager Platform Architect Platform Developer HTML Developer Campaign Specialists Deliverability Specialist
	Duration	4-6 weeks	3-6 months	4-8 months	12 months+
	Cost	\$150K-\$300K	\$300K-700K	\$500K-\$1MM	\$325K+



Merkury Tag

PRODUCT



Merkury Tag for Personalized Messaging

Use real-time, person-level identification to deliver personalized content across channels and boost outcomes

MONTH 00, 2023



The ecosystem of digital identity solutions is fragmented and has limitations

FOCUS AREAS

LIMITATIONS

VALUE ADD

WEB ANALYTICS



Cookie and device-based identification of visits for site reporting & analysis

No person ID graph and ID resolution capabilities.
No real-time data & identity capabilities to enable experiences.

RETARGETING



Cookie, device and person-based identification of visits for retargeting across media and CRM trigger programs

Limited person ID graph and ID resolution capabilities.
Limited integration with data, mar-tech, data management systems, and ad tech.

CDP



Cookie, device and person-based identification of visits for real-time customer experience orchestration

Limited 1st Party Identity Graph and ID resolution capabilities
Limited real-time data enhancement and activation connections.

IDENTITY



ID graph and resolution capabilities focused on customer data onboarding and targeting across media and martech

Limited 1st-party real-time digital identity and data capabilities.
Limited linkage of offline to digital identity. Limited identity graph transparency and ownership provided.



Inform your entire business ecosystem with a persistent digital identity to support business value



Personalization at scale powered by the Merkury Tag

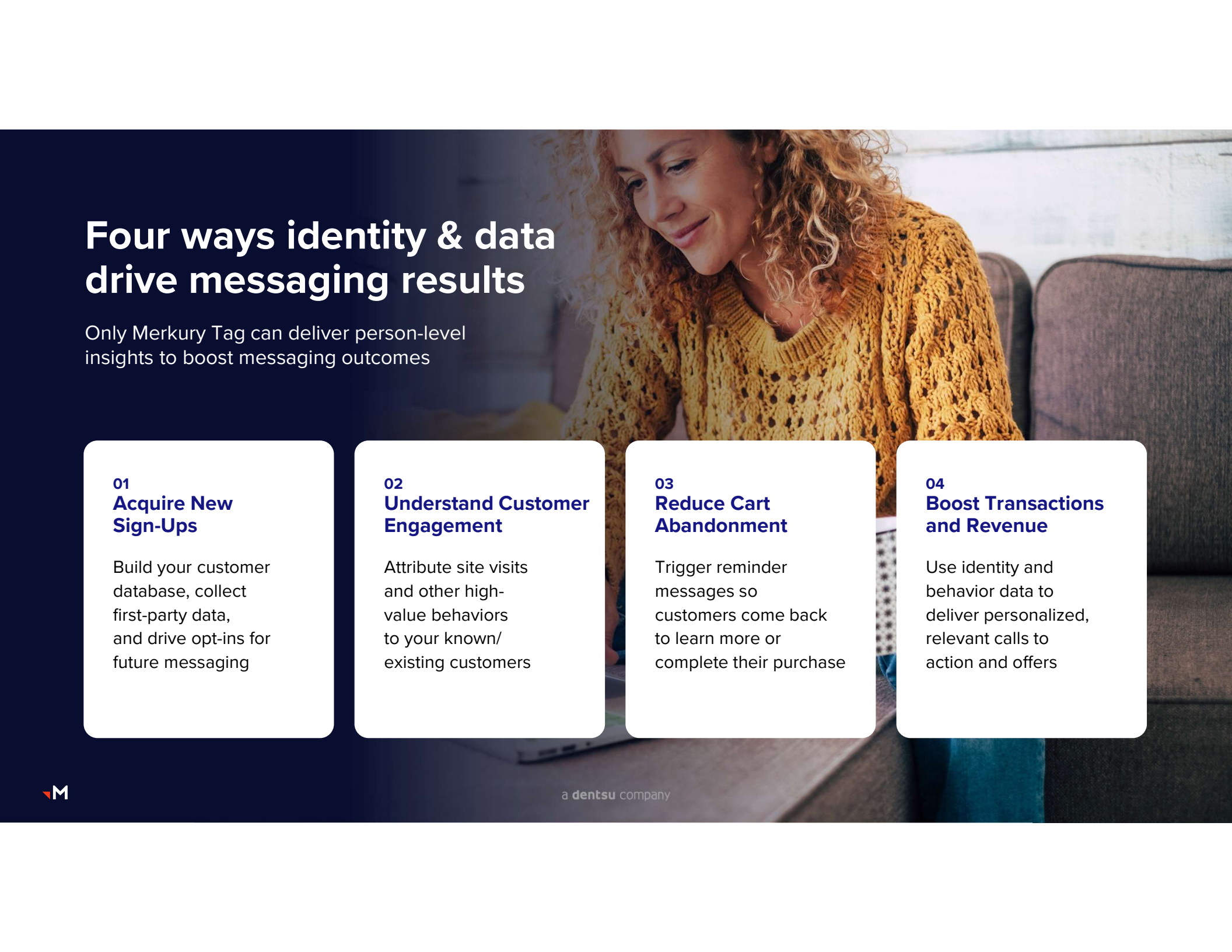


Merkury Tag is a must-have for personalized messaging at scale.

It enables privacy-compliant, person-based identification of anonymous website visitors by using a small embedded website component and real-time integration with the brand's messaging platform.

Merkury Tag identifies more anonymous website visitors and attributes their behaviors.

The result is deeper customer insight that informs segmentation, targeting, and offers strategy to deliver personalized content and calls to action through messaging across channels.



Four ways identity & data drive messaging results

Only Merkury Tag can deliver person-level insights to boost messaging outcomes

01 Acquire New Sign-Ups

Build your customer database, collect first-party data, and drive opt-ins for future messaging

02 Understand Customer Engagement

Attribute site visits and other high-value behaviors to your known/existing customers

03 Reduce Cart Abandonment

Trigger reminder messages so customers come back to learn more or complete their purchase

04 Boost Transactions and Revenue

Use identity and behavior data to deliver personalized, relevant calls to action and offers



a dentsu company

Merkury Tag for Messaging: How it Works

STEP 1

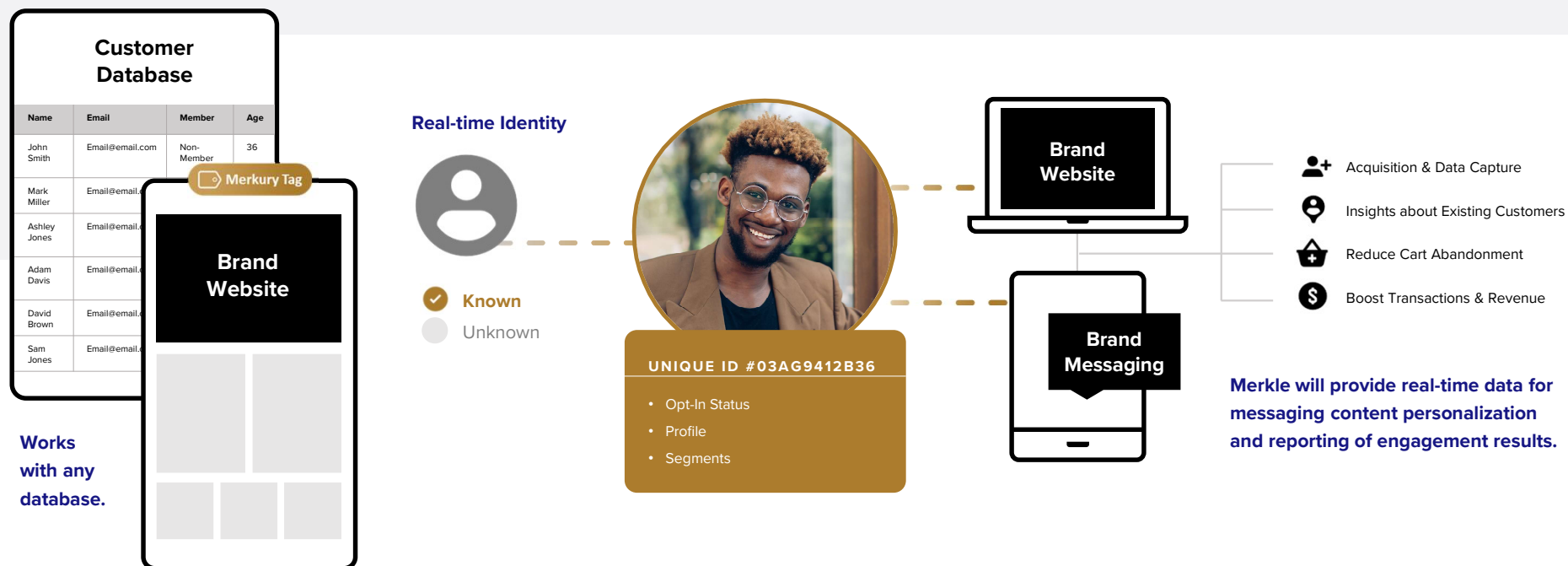
Merkury Tag is embedded on brand website and Merkury is connected to brand's master customer or CRM database.

STEP 2

When anonymous users visit the brand website, Merkury resolves identity in real time to either a known or unknown customer.

STEP 3

Messaging and site content can be targeted to acquire unknowns and better engage known customers with compelling calls to action.



LIFESTYLE BRAND

Increase identification for lifestyle brand

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

This global lifestyle brand struggled with a high rate of cart and product abandonment among visitors to their website. Their existing triggered email program was not identifying enough of these abandoners to enable effective follow-up, so the brand was losing millions of dollars in revenue each year.

MERKLE SOLUTION

The Merkury Tag was deployed on the brand's website to increase identification of both known and unknown site visitors and attribute the cart and product abandonment to those customers. This improved the performance of the brand's triggered email journey for abandoners.

BUSINESS IMPACT

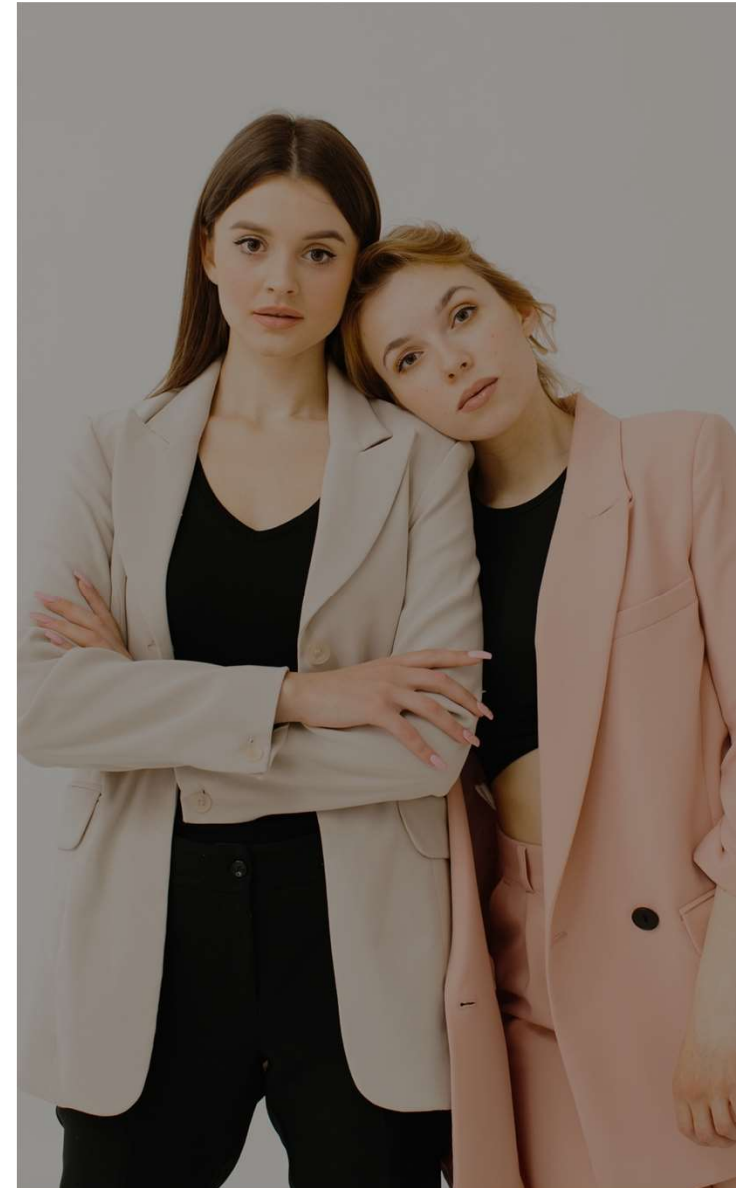
All results are incremental to the client's existing provider

Nearly 250% lift

in site visitor
identification

188% increase

in remarketing triggered
emails delivered



SMITH & NOBLE

Capturing first-party data

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Smith & Noble needed to capture more first-party data to identify existing customers and understand the products and services they were interested in.

MERKLE SOLUTION

The Merkury Tag was deployed on the brand's website, and Merkury Lightboxes were used to capture first-party data from previously anonymous site visitors. The Lightboxes also engaged previous subscribers who were inactive to encourage re-subscribe.

BUSINESS IMPACT

50% increase

in new email subscribers
each week

10% of total acquisitions

are re-engagement from inactive
customers

“Merkury has been able to re-engage and re-subscribe a significant number of individuals that are unsubscribed in our email database. This re-engagement of inactive emails amounts to almost 10% of our total email address acquisition per week.”

Andrew Sampson

Digital Marketing Manager, Smith & Noble



LUXURY RETAILER

Luxury Retailer

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

This large luxury retailer experienced an anonymous website visitor rate higher than 75% and struggled to attribute online engagement to in-store purchases.

MERKLE SOLUTION

- The Merkury Tag was deployed on the brand's website to resolve anonymous visitors to a person-level identity and the client's first-party CRM system was integrated so that identity was available in real time.
- Merkle additionally made identity data available to the client's martech partner systems (CDP, Analytics, ESP, etc.) to power personalized messaging.
- This increased identification led to more personalized site experiences, increased marketing activation, and improved offline-to-online attribution.

6X+ lift

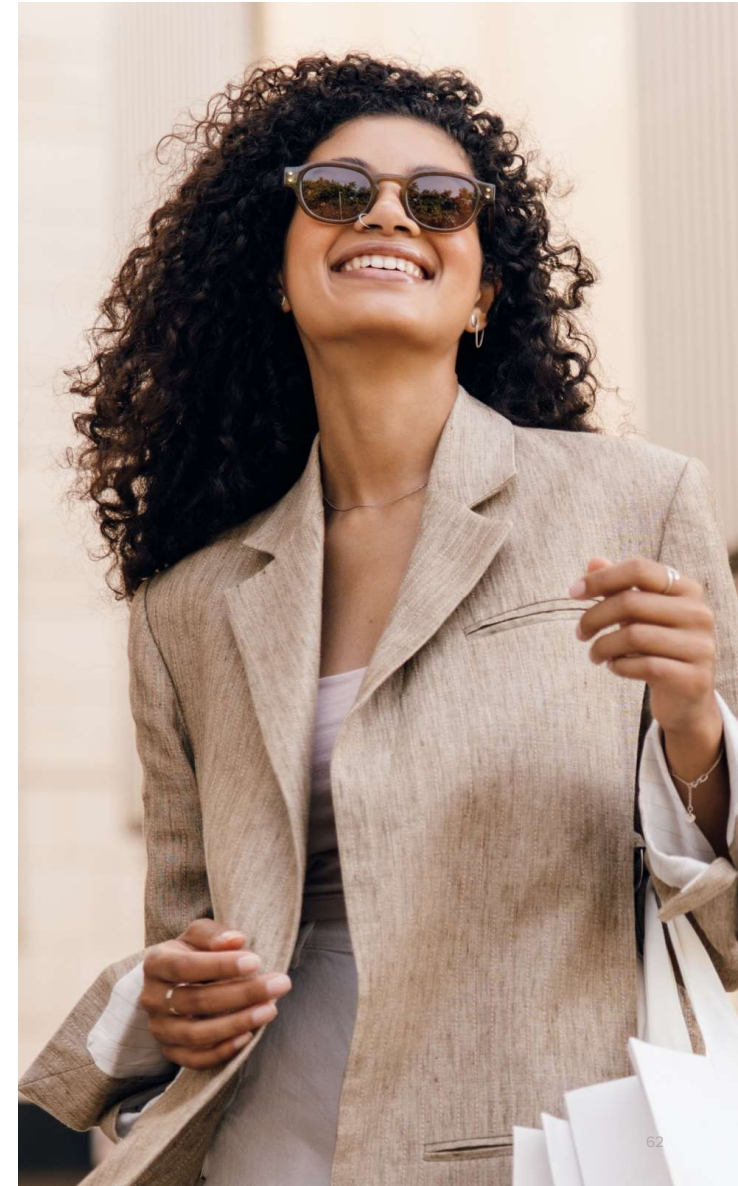
in real-time
identification rate

\$3M per month

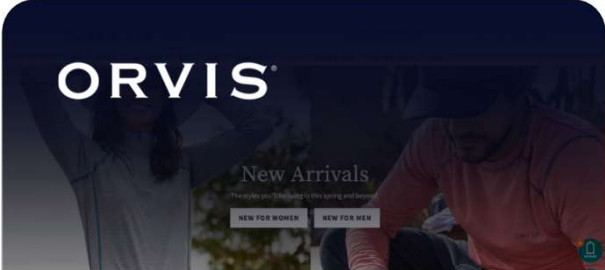
incremental revenue from site
abandonment email

70%

identification rate among
anonymous website visitors



Retailer Successes in Triggered Messaging

		
CHALLENGE Identify more anonymous site visitors in order to deliver more personalized customer experiences.	Increase trigger email volume by increasing email match to person-level identity.	Increase identification of unknown customers to engage with more relevant messaging.
RESULTS 44% more abandon cart emails sent 20% more abandon product emails sent \$1M+ in incremental revenue	300% lift in abandon cart emails sent 25% increase in open rates 70% increase in email revenue	nearly 8x more trigger emails sent each month 100%+ better click-through rate \$3.2M in incremental revenue



Enables better customer experiences and brand outcomes

Identify More Visitors

Use the Merkury reference database of 268MM US adults 18+ to identify more anonymous site visitors

Enable Cross-channel

Make relevant customer and behavior data available across your MarTech stack

Optimize Strategy

Use person-level identity and data to improve segmentation, targeting, journey, and measurement strategy

Personalize CTAs

Real-time, personalized calls to action to drive valuable behaviors

Deliver Value

Show compelling content and offers informed by profiles and preferences

Boost Engagement

Acquire and engage customers more effectively and consistently across channels

dentsu Insights

PRODUCT



Automated Email Reporting



INTERNAL



FAQ

1. What is this?

- A low-cost, time-efficient offering to automate custom email reporting for both internal and client use.

2. Who is this offering for?

- Any clients who receive (or want to receive) email reporting.

3. Why did we create it?

- As an alternative to Excel reports which are error-prone, take manual effort, and not 'always on'.
- As an alternative to the generic out-of-the-box reports provided by ESPs.

4. Why would I want to use it for my clients?

- Easy way to set the foundation for growing a comprehensive reporting environment.
- Allows internal team to focus on more impactful client work like insights and recommendations.

5. How does it work?

- Export data from the ESP to a secured storage location.
- Build Tableau dashboards on that data.
- Publish dashboards to Dentsu Insights.

Process, Cost, and Timeline

	PROCESS	DETAILS	OWNER
1. Data Files	The data files (up to 2) containing all required data are put in a secured storage location (SFTP, GCS, or S3).	These files will be in a reporting-ready format. "Reporting-ready" means no blending or joining of the data is required in order to support the dashboard.	DEG/Digital Messaging resources* remain on to ensure queries and exports run as expected.
2. Data Tables	The data files (up to 2) are picked up from the storage location and put into a Big Query or Snowflake table.	No data transformation will be done between the file and the table. (File and table schema will be the same.)	Data Onboarding rolls off after 3 weeks.
3. Tableau Dashboards	The dashboards (up to 2) will be developed and published to Dentsu Insights.	Dashboards can have light customizations (branded colors, client logo, etc.).	Data Viz remains on to add and remove users and do small dashboard updates as needed.

\$Annual Cost: \$50k

(includes up to 2 dashboards).

*This cost includes resources from Data Onboarding and Data Viz only.

Timeline: 4 weeks to stand up
(starting from the day we have access to reporting-ready data)

Beyond the Basics

These scenarios can be accommodated but may increase cost from **\$50k**

1. Data Files

- Writing the query in the platform (e.g.: against the SFMC send log) to produce a reporting-ready file
- If Alteryx is in use today, we will investigate those processes so they can be implemented elsewhere

2. Data Tables

~\$25k

Blending data sources
(e.g.: email and site data)

~\$10k

Bringing in look up tables to
account for 'missing' taxonomy

3. Tableau Dashboards

- Developing more than 2 dashboards
- Using more than 1 currency in the dashboards
- Implementing additional access restrictions (e.g.: row level security)

~\$10k

Bringing in historical email data
(greater than 30 days ago)

***Estimated additional costs**

About the Dashboards

QC of the dashboards:

QC will be done by the client's account team (e.g.: a campaign manager). If it is desired instead that the QC be done by dashboard developers, they will need access to the ESP. This would likely increase cost.

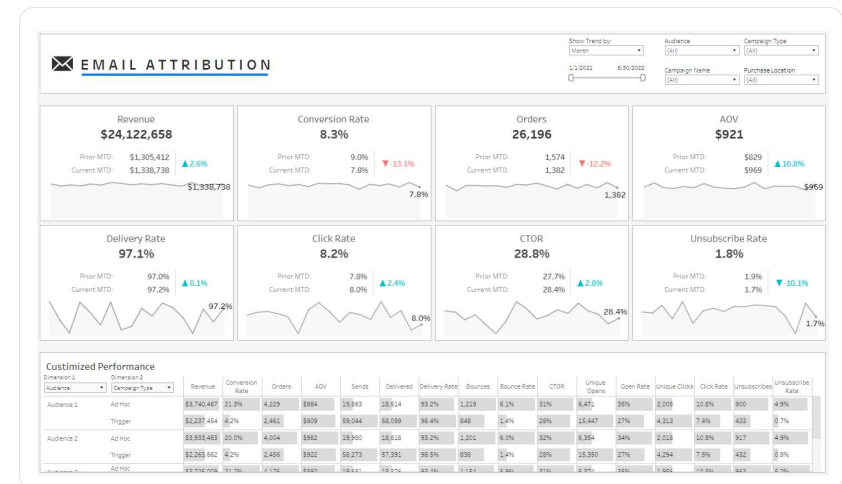
Using the dashboards:

- Client and internal users will have on-demand access to the dashboards through Dentsu Insights.
- Dashboards can be edited over time as the business evolves.
- Dashboards can be demoed via Dentsu Insights or exported to ppt or pdf if desired.
- Underlying data can be exported into a CSV or Excel if desired.

Dashboard access:

Permissions will be managed by the Data Viz team at the client level.

- If a more granular permission structure is needed (e.g.: client has multiple brands that can't have access to each other's data) this can be accommodated (would require additional time and documentation during discovery).



CAN USE BRANDED COLORS, LOGO, AND WORDING.

Next Steps

Set up time to discuss client needs with
Julie Connolly jconnolly@merkleinc.com
or Amanda Gessert agessert@merkleinc.com

Once that's done, we'll set up a group
call to discuss details (refresh cadence,
where data will land, etc.)

**Work begins once we have alignment
on pricing and client / legal approval**

Sales Enablement

These assets can be used externally, unless marked otherwise. We've included one-pagers on the value prop, and overviews of the launched offerings.

LEARN THE OFFERING

01

Buyers & Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

02

Commercial Guidance

Guidance on pricepoint, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.

03

Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

04

Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

05

SME Contacts

Have questions? Reach out to the offering owner or regional point person. They can help you present or tailor this content for your needs.

OFFERING

CRM & Messaging



Buyers & Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

CMO, CIO/CTO, Director of Marketing/CRM

Our buyers are responsible for leveraging CRM & Messaging to drive revenue growth from new and existing customers. They are often responsible for ensuring effective journey management at every consumer interaction point across every digital channel.

This requires focus on targeting, personalization, creating a consistent omni-channel experience, and the ability to scale incremental gains. All of this requires a deep understanding of the technologies and partners that support omni-channel messaging delivery—as well as the delivery itself.

Budget Ownership

Typically, a mixture of Marketing and IT budgets, although not always in an even distribution. Some clients can categorize investment in a new platform or ESP as a capital expenditure, providing additional budget flexibility for use towards ongoing services.

Rising Acquisition Costs

Diminishing return on ad spend (ROAS) has forced brands to refocus on driving growth from their existing customer base.

Underleveraged Technology

Brands often lack resources or expertise to leverage their tech investments or evolve their marketing programs to drive more sophisticated, connected experiences.

Disconnected Channel Strategy

Brands must create more cohesive, consistent, and customer-centric omnichannel experiences across their digital and physical properties.

Increased Competition

The battle for consumer attention has created a need for more targeted, relevant, and dynamic/non-linear customer journey management.

The Pace of Innovation

Brands can get lost trying to navigate the “hype”—they are expected to innovate, but don’t often know how to prioritize these industry trends to more meaningfully impact their business.

OUTCOMES OBSESSION

We are obsessed with outcomes. From maximizing the return on value of technology investments to delivering data-driven strategies for measurable business improvement, our performance heritage fuels our focus.

Outcome	Why it Matters
Delivery Accuracy & Deliverability	Sending the wrong message to the wrong customer can create a poor experience and result in significant financial impact.
Customer Acquisition	The more consumers you can reach the more you can influence with your message.
Engagement	Delivering relevant experiences keeps customers engaged and is critical to driving revenue growth and retention.
Conversion	The ultimate measure of message relevancy and revenue impact— attribution models can really demonstrate the power of email.

OFFERING

CRM & Messaging



Buyers & Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

TARGET INDUSTRIES

Describe specific industries or verticals where this offering is particularly relevant.

Industry	Why it Matters	What to listen for	Do we have vertical-specific content?
Retail, Consumer Goods	Often less conservative than other verticals, making them more open to invest and experiment with emerging technologies. Also, are typically able to more directly attribute performance to revenue.	- Unhappy with throughput or reliability of technology for larger, more real-time audiences - Desire to expand channel capabilities into SMS, Chat, Push/In-App, etc. - Hiring of a new CMO/CIO who may push to change tech based on past experiences	Some, particularly around customer journeys
Financial Services, Insurance	Slower to evolve and more likely to be stuck on monolithic, legacy systems in dire need of modernization. Often need a lot of hand-holding in choosing new technology investments that “play nice” with legacy systems. Can also be slower to adopt due to regulation and security concerns.	- Legacy systems that require an upgrade (directly/indirectly)—may be more cost-effective to migrate to a new, more modern solution - Desire to expand channel capabilities into SMS, Chat, Push/In-App, etc. - Relationship between Marketing and IT—tends to be more fraught due to marketing needs vis-à-vis tech limitations - Desire to do heavy prospecting or make firm offers of credit, which would dictate our tech recommendations and/or approach	Some, but more around our experience working within regulated industries in general
Healthcare, Pharma	Tend to be bifurcated between consumers/patients and health care professionals (HCPs), which has an impact on the types of technologies they can—and are willing to—adopt.	- Specific needs related to hosting and management of consumer/patient and HCP data - Need for multiple business units or parent-child relationships within the platform for drug brands, etc. - Platform capabilities specific to their vertical (e.g., Salesforce Health Cloud, Veeva, etc.) - Unique legal/approval processes for campaigns	Some, but more around our experience working within regulated industries in general
Emerging Markets	Mixed bag but tend to have more modern tech stacks and are more willing to “disrupt” or lean into new innovations.	Varies since this is a catch-all, but tend to lean towards more “best of breed” technologies rather than wanting to invest in a single marketing cloud ecosystem	Varies

OFFERING

CRM & Messaging

Commercial Guidance

Guidance on pricepoint, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.

INTERNAL

ABOUT THE MARKET	Who it's for	Brands that want to drive growth from their existing customer base.	Global email marketing market predicted to grow from \$1.26B in 2022 to \$2.76B by 2029.	Average deal for implementation is \$500K; average for implementation + pull-through is roughly \$850K-\$1MM
	Key competitors	Epsilon / Publicis	Accenture	
		Zeta	Deloitte	
		Platform-specific services / integrators (e.g., Salesforce, Adobe, Slalom, ListEngage, Lev, etc.)		
	Key Alliances	Salesforce, Adobe, Braze		

OFFERING

CRM & Messaging

Commercial Guidance

Guidance on pricepoint, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.

INTERNAL					
SELLING THE OFFERING	WEDGE (Under \$100k USD)	Messaging Tech Assessment	Technical focus. Assess the current state of Digital Messaging technology, understand business objectives, and identify opportunities to increase efficiency and maximize customer engagement		\$80K - \$100K
	WEDGE (Under \$100k USD)	Messaging Strategy Assessment	Merkle's Messaging Assessment helps brands create more connected journeys for customers through a deep understanding of messaging strategy and innovative creative combined with data strategy and technology enablement.		\$50K - \$75K
	PACKAGED ENGAGEMENT Operating Model Assessment: Focused	CRM Strategy Blueprint	A comprehensive assessment & strategy, including CRM opportunity, strategic plan, approach and design, complete with a roadmap and prioritized opportunities and requirements.		M: \$100K - \$250K L: \$250K - \$350K
		CRM Implementation or Migration	Transition clients from one ESP to another, including setup/configuration of the new platform, migration of assets (content, data, campaign logic, certain integrations) to the new platform, IP warming, and go-live.	S: \$150K-\$300K M: \$300K-\$700K L: \$700K+	

OFFERING

CRM & Messaging



Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

OUR STORY

We're experts in the Messaging space and have been a part of Merkle since the mid-2000s. Since then, we've continued to grow and evolve—both internally and via acquisition—going from \$8MM+ in annual revenue in 2014 to over \$61MM in 2023 (663% growth).

- Our Messaging practice combines years of experience across Merkle and DEG to form a cohesive offering driven by expertise as both a systems integrator and a full-service, end-to-end services shop
- We have extensive resources supporting the Salesforce ecosystem—particularly around Marketing Cloud (Engagement) and Core (Sales/Service)
- We also have significant expertise and experience supporting the Adobe environment, Braze, Responsys, and various non-profit platforms (e.g., Blackbaud, etc.); we're also expanding into tools like Iterable and Bloomreach where it makes sense
- Our core team is comprised of over 250 people in the US and India, working to deliver nearly 20 billion messages per year across 29,000+ deployed campaigns at a 99.7% accuracy rate—our rigorous delivery model can adapt and scale to our clients' individual programs without compromising speed (depending on complexity) or quality
- We're one of the few agencies in the market to feature a dedicated team of Deliverability experts who can act as a liaison between clients and Internet service providers (ISP) or spam blockers; this has created a key point of differentiation for us—especially in regulated industries—since these capabilities have, historically, been limited to ESPs

MARKET VALIDATION



Customer Database and Engagement Agencies Leader
2021

Marketing Services Leader & Star Performer
2023





OFFERING

CRM & Messaging

Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

PRODUCTS

Merkle’s products, including GenCX and Merkury, offer industry-leading capabilities. Many offerings leverage these products to deliver strengthened client outcomes. Having Merkle-owned platforms in use client-side also strengthens our relationships with key clients.

Product	How it’s used	Outcomes	Commercial Considerations
Merkury Tag	Merkury Tag is embedded on a brand’s website to identify anonymous visitors and support messaging use cases: acquire new sign-ups, understand customer engagement, reduce cart abandonment, boost transactions and revenue	- Identify more anonymous customers so messaging can be personalized - Drive sign-up/opt-in for future messaging - Boost incremental revenue by sending more cart abandonment and product browse abandonment emails	Can be implemented with a new CRM implementation or added to an existing one for a set-up fee. Tag license on client’s website (monthly) is based on number of monthly site sessions (visits).
Dentsu Insight	Provides a lightly-customized, out-of-the-box alternative to basic reporting offered by ESPs, allowing for deeper insights and broader metrics than customers would have by default.	- Enables multi-channel analysis in a single, rolled-up view - Enables light channel attribution - Provides better tools for sharing and socialization within the client org - Allows client to slice insights by dimension	- Typically hosted by Merkle/dentsu—if client wants to host, we’d need to adjust the offering - Implementation is about a six-week process at \$50-\$70K, plus infrastructure - Ongoing maintenance and optimization carries a nominal annual cost (onshore + offshore)



OFFERING

CRM & Messaging



Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

CASE STUDIES

Include at least three case studies related to your offering. If you have cases already built out, feel free to include in this deck.

Client	Project	Market	Description	Outcomes
Neutrogena	Messaging and ecommerce development, delivery and ongoing management	CPG	Over the holidays, we implemented Neutrogena's exclusive Holiday Shop while creating and delivering messaging strategies to raise consumer awareness and revenue.	• 56% YoY increase in revenue • 16.8% Email Conversion rate – more than 6% increase from previous year • 50% YOY Increase in web traffic
Salvation Army	Creative development and ongoing campaign management	Non-Profit	Merkle leveraged omni-channel messaging to helped reconnect Salvation Army donors to the issues of Food Insecurity and Anti-Human Trafficking. Using a story-telling approach we focused on building human connections through emotions.	• Food Insecurity revenue increased by 3%. • Anti-Human Trafficking revenue increased by 38%
Sam's Club	Salesforce Migration & Ongoing Campaign Management	Retail	Merkle helped Sam's Club migrate to Salesforce Marketing Cloud, then partnered with them to move beyond messaging to focus on evolving the member experience, online and in the warehouse.	• The work pushed their capabilities forward and, at the same time, freed their product leaders to focus on long term business objectives.

OFFERING

CRM & Messaging



Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

Consulting Approach / Platform Knowledge

WHAT IT IS

Deep expertise in Salesforce Marketing Cloud, Adobe Campaign, Braze, and Oracle Responsys allows for platform-agnostic insights, transformation, etc.

WHY IT WORKS

Partner-level certifications that allow us to perform independent implementations without partner supervision

Understanding of multiple platforms helps with migration work, third-party integrations, etc.

KEY OUTCOMES

- More efficient implementations and migrations
- Cost savings from using ESP professional services (in most cases)
- Multi-platform expertise allows our partnership to “travel” with the client if they make a tech change in the future

Email Deliverability Services

WHAT IT IS

Dedicated team of Deliverability experts that can guide and assist clients with IP warming, ISP remediation, Spam houses/blacklists, deliverability strategy, insights, etc.

WHY IT WORKS

Typically, Deliverability teams are exclusive to ESPs—we’re one of the few agencies with a dedicated team, allowing for more personalized and timely response times for clients

Option for dedicated resources for larger accounts (e.g., Sanofi)

KEY OUTCOMES

- Faster remediation
- More specialized and personalized monitoring—especially during peak season
- Inbox deliverability rates above 95%



OFFERING

CRM & Messaging



Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

OUTCOMES OBSESSION

Our best clients buy outcomes, not activities or outputs. Outline for our client partners the key outcomes this offering drives and why it's critical to our clients and prospects. Include references or benchmarks if you have them.

- Revenue expansion from base (see Neutrogena case)
- Increased CRM database growth
- Deeper levels of engagement through personalization
- Better more connected omni-channel customer experience

WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

- Client is unhappy with current Email Service Provider (ESP)
- Client is looking to reconfigure and/or optimize their existing ESP
- Client perceives a gap in current messaging capabilities or maturity
- Client has expressed that they feel their messaging program is stagnant
- Client is seeking innovative ideas to expand their messaging program
- Client is ready to expand siloed messaging plans to an orchestrated cross-channel experience
- Recent change in CMO (or similar decision-making role) at client

QUALIFYING QUESTIONS

- What are the gaps in your current-state tools or capabilities?
- Do you feel as if you're getting the most out of your ESP investment?
- Are you ready to think about orchestrating and automating existing messaging?
- Are you ready to think about orchestrating messaging across channels?
- How are your customer retention and/or acquisition efforts?

OFFERING
CRM & Messaging



SME Contact

Have questions? Reach out to the offering owner or regional point person. They can help you present or tailor this content for your needs.

OWNER



James Reiss
SVP, GM Loyalty & Messaging Experience
AMER

AMER



Lisa Burgess
SVP, Messaging Delivery Lead



Chris Cottgias
VP, Messaging Solutions



Lisa Katz
SVP, Client Strategy

EMEA

APAC

About Merkle's 2024 GTM



OUR VISION IS TO BE THE BUSINESS THAT IS

PURPOSE-BUILT TO POWER EXPERIENCE TRANSFORMATION

We put people at the heart of what we do

We believe experience-led business transformation results in uncommon growth, profitability, and long-term customer value

We are the only integrated experience consultancy ready for an AI-first future

We balance creativity and practicality by integrating design, strategy, technology, and data all as first-class citizens – the ability for a single firm to handle strategy, design, and implementation is a **top two** selection criteria (Forrester)

We deliver multi-dimensional industry, domain, and technology platform expertise

Technology and industry expertise are **top two** and **three** selection criteria for a partner respectively (Forrester); industry expertise and deep alliance partnerships are force multipliers for our business

We are obsessed with outcomes

From maximizing the return on value of technology investments to delivering data-driven strategies for measurable business improvement, our performance heritage fuels our focus

OUR PROMISE

We power the experience economy.

OUR PROPOSITIONS



OUR CAPABILITIES



OUR PRODUCTS



OUR PROMISE

We **power** the experience economy.

OUR PROPOSITIONS



Growth & Business Agility



Future-Ready Technology



Customer-First Experiences



Brand Loyalty & Engagement

Offerings

OUR CAPABILITIES

EXPERIENCE & PRODUCT DESIGN

ENGAGEMENT & LOYALTY

PLATFORMS & ENGINEERING

ANALYTICS & INSIGHTS

CONSULTING & BUSINESS OPERATIONS

Services

OUR PRODUCTS

MERKURY

GENCX

GTM BUSINESS ARCHITECTURE

EXTERNAL

INTERNAL

OUR PROMISE

Our differentiated perspective on the market and right to play

- Why we do what we do (theory of the firm) and an expression of our market vision
- The role we play in unlocking the broader dentsu integrated value proposition

OUR PROPOSITIONS & OFFERINGS

The territories brands must address to win in the experience economy; value propositions are gateways for us to have insightful, consultative conversations with the market focused on business value drivers

Offerings

What we repeatedly and reliably do as a business to address challenges and seize on the opportunities identified in value propositions

- A common foundation for our marketing, verticals, and alliances
- A mechanism to: increase the portability of our best work and thinking across regions and teams; integrate interdisciplinary capabilities, services, and teams in service of client outcomes
- An integration layer for Merkle to cross-dentsu and practice solutions

OUR CAPABILITIES & PRODUCTS

Capabilities: Five common capabilities that answer the question: "what exactly do we do?" Validated as contemporary and future-looking capabilities against competitors, with analysts, and a small group of trusted, senior client buyers across functions (CTOs, CMOs, CDOs, CXOs)

Services: A more granular services breakdown related to our five capabilities

Validated as contemporary and future-looking capabilities against competitors, with analysts, and a small group of trusted, senior client buyers across functions (CTOs, CMOs, CDOs, CXOs) and markets.

Products: Market-leading technologies that not only amplify our work, but available directly to clients.



a dentsu company

